

Paper and Paperboard Packaging Market

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DESCRIPTION	TABLE OF CONTENTS	METHODOLOGY	DOWNLOAD PDF
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Paper and Paperboard Packaging Market by Grade (SBS, CUK, FBB, WLC, Glassine & Greaseproof, Label Paper), Type (Corrugated Box, Boxboard, Flexible Paper), Source, Pulping, Application (Food, Beverage, Personal & Homecare), & Region - Global Forecast to 2030

CAGR 2.9% (2025-2030)	USD 451.8 MARKET SIZE, 2030	315 REPORT PAGES	300 MARKET TABLES
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OVERVIEW



Source: Secondary Research, Interviews with Experts, MarketsandMarkets Analysis

The paper and paperboard packaging market is expected to reach USD 451.80 billion by 2030, up from USD 391.07 billion in 2025, growing at a CAGR of 2.9%. The sector's growth is driven by demand for sustainable packaging, recyclable and biodegradable products, and the rise of e-commerce requiring lighter, stronger packaging. Industries like food, beverage, pharmaceuticals, and cosmetics increasingly use paper-based packaging to boost branding and sustainability. Factors fueling growth include awareness of plastic waste reduction, new legislation against single-use plastics, and innovation in packaging design for durability and aesthetics. Developing economies will particularly drive this growth due to urbanization and industrialization.

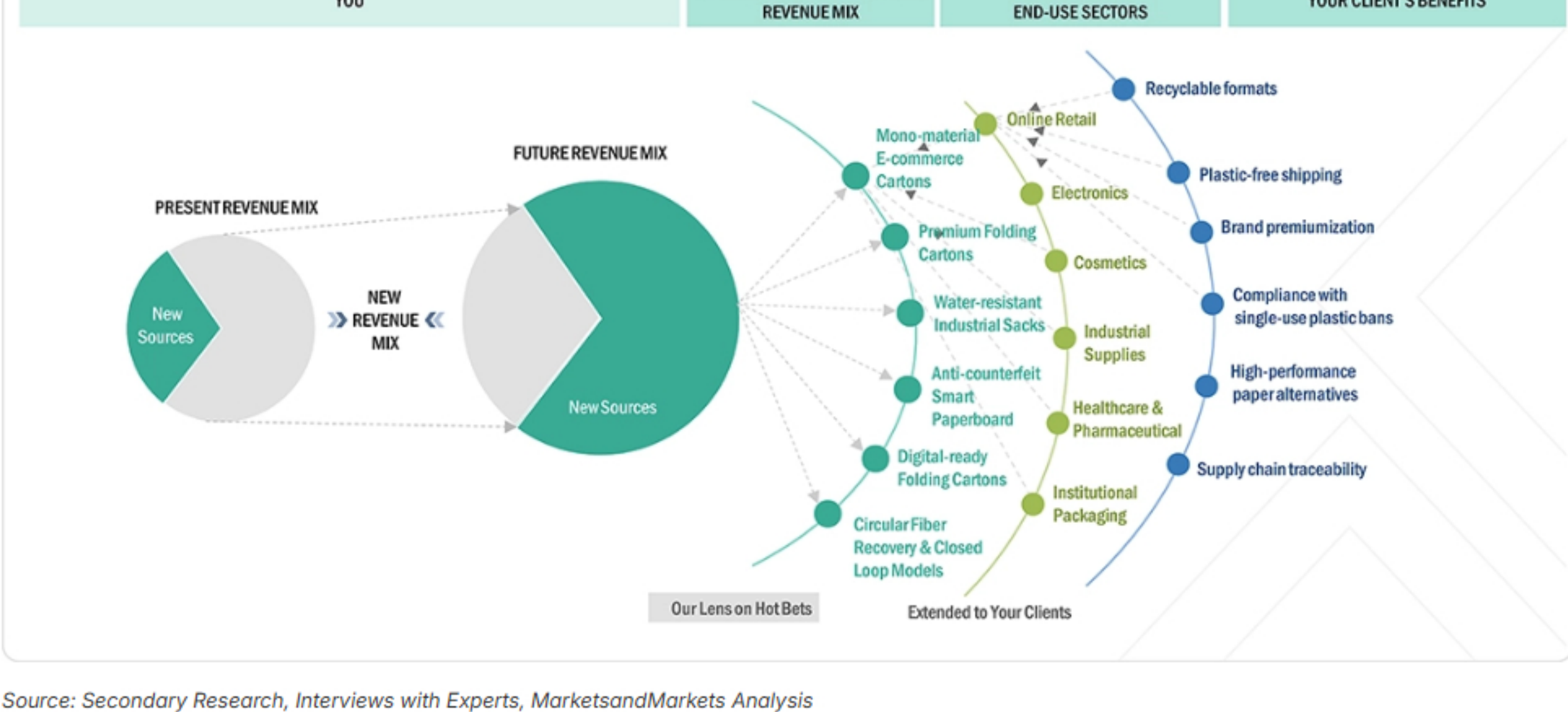
KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The paper and paperboard packaging market is categorized by type into corrugated boxes, boxboard, and flexible paper. Corrugated boxes dominate the market due to several reasons, such as acceptance in various multiple application areas (food, beverages, healthcare, e-commerce, etc.). Corrugated boxes provide low-cost packaging solutions that can be customized according to the consumer's needs.
- The solid bleached sulphates (SBS) segment held the largest market share in the paper and paperboard packaging market due to its premium quality, excellent printability, and durability. It is versatile and provides good protection for a wide range of products, but it is commonly used in food, beverage, and luxury packaging applications.
- Food holds the largest share in the paper and paperboard packaging applications market due to the increasing demand for sustainable, eco-friendly, safe, and functional packaging for all types of food. It offers lightweight, easily recyclable packaging options that can be customized according to the consumer's needs.
- The Asia Pacific is expected to grow fastest, with a CAGR of 3.2%, driven by growing urbanization, rising demand from end-use application areas such as food, beverage, healthcare, etc.
- Mondi Group (UK), International Paper (US), Amcor (Switzerland), Smurfit Kappa (Ireland), and Oji Holdings Corporation (Japan) are leading companies of the paper and paperboard packaging market. These companies are pursuing both organic and inorganic growth strategies, such as product launches, acquisitions, and expansions, to increase their market presence.

The paper & paperboard packaging market is expected to see moderate growth due to several factors, such as the expanding e-commerce industry, the need for better packaging materials, the demand to reduce plastic waste, etc. Consumers are becoming increasingly environmentally friendly, leading producers to emphasize paper and paperboard packaging over conventional technologies. This is particularly evident in the food and personal care segments.

TRENDS & DISRUPTIONS IMPACTING CUSTOMERS' CUSTOMERS

The impact on consumers' business emerges from customer trends or disruptions. Hot belts are the clients of paper and paperboard packaging manufacturers, and target applications are the clients of paper & paperboard packaging manufacturers. Shifts, which are changing trends or disruptions, will impact the revenues of end users. The revenue impact on end users will affect the revenue of hotbeds, which will further affect the revenues of paper & paperboard packaging manufacturers



Source: Secondary Research, Interviews with Experts, MarketsandMarkets Analysis

MARKET DYNAMICS

DRIVERS	RESTRAINTS	OPPORTUNITIES	CHALLENGES
- Growth in demand for recyclable mailers and corrugated inserts in E-commerce packaging - Recyclability of paper and paperboard a key driver in adoption of sustainable packaging	- Limited barrier properties as compared to plastics and materials - Price volatility of raw materials	- Integration of smart packaging technologies with paperboard formats - Adoption of agro-residue and alternative fibers in paperboard production	- Balancing recyclability with barrier performance in food applications - Tightening deforestation regulations limiting virgin fiber sourcing

Source: Secondary Research, Interviews with Experts, MarketsandMarkets Analysis

Driver: Growth in demand for recyclable mailers and corrugated inserts in E-commerce packaging	+
Restraint: Limited barrier properties as compared to plastics and materials	+
Opportunity: Integration of smart packaging technologies with paperboard formats	+
Challenge: Balancing recyclability with barrier performance in food applications	+

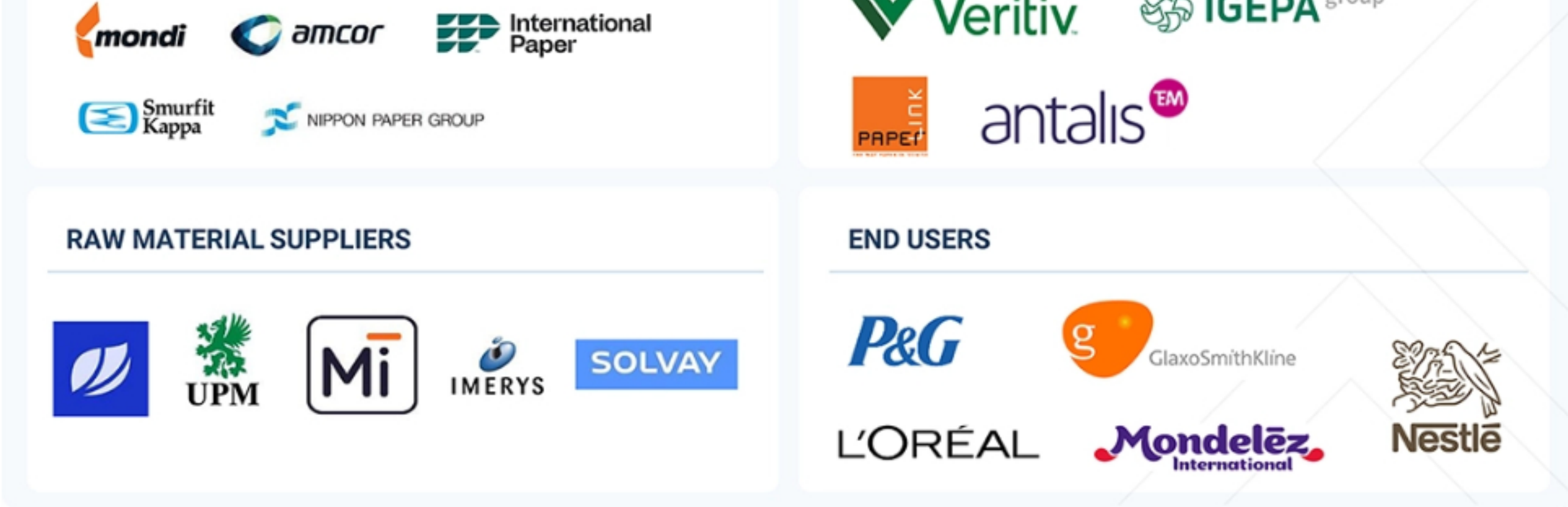
PAPER AND PAPERBOARD PACKAGING MARKET: COMMERCIAL USE CASES ACROSS INDUSTRIES

COMPANY	USE CASE DESCRIPTION	BENEFITS
	Green Bay Packaging sought to digitize and optimize its recycling operations to eliminate inefficiencies associated with manual processes, improve inspection tracking, and enhance overall operational efficiency.	The company implemented Augmentir's Connected Worker solution to digitize processes for plant inspections, facility checks, safety checklists, and auditing procedures. This digital transformation eliminated manual data capture, provided enhanced documentation for OEM and warranty communications, and standardized inspections across multiple sites. The adoption of this technology led to improved accountability, streamlined operations, and a more efficient recycling process.
	Priwatt, a German solar energy company, aimed to enhance its packaging to support increased production volumes and reduce damage rates during transportation. The existing packaging was not sufficiently robust, leading to product damages and inefficiencies in the supply chain	Smurfit Kappa partnered with Priwatt to develop an improved packaging solution tailored to the specific needs of solar panels. The new design focused on enhancing protection, reducing material usage, and optimizing the packaging process. As a result, Priwatt more than tripled its daily output and significantly reduced damage rates, leading to cost savings and improved customer satisfaction.
	Metsä Board, a leading European producer of premium fresh fiber paperboards, sought to improve the functionality, recyclability, and brand impact of its customers' packaging solutions. The company aimed to maximize product performance while minimizing both, carbon footprint and costs	Metsä Board implemented the 3DEXPERIENCE platform to enhance its packaging design and development processes. This digital solution enabled the company to create innovative, sustainable packaging solutions that met customer demands for both performance and environmental responsibility. The platform facilitated collaboration across teams, streamlined workflows, and reduced time-to-market for new packaging designs.

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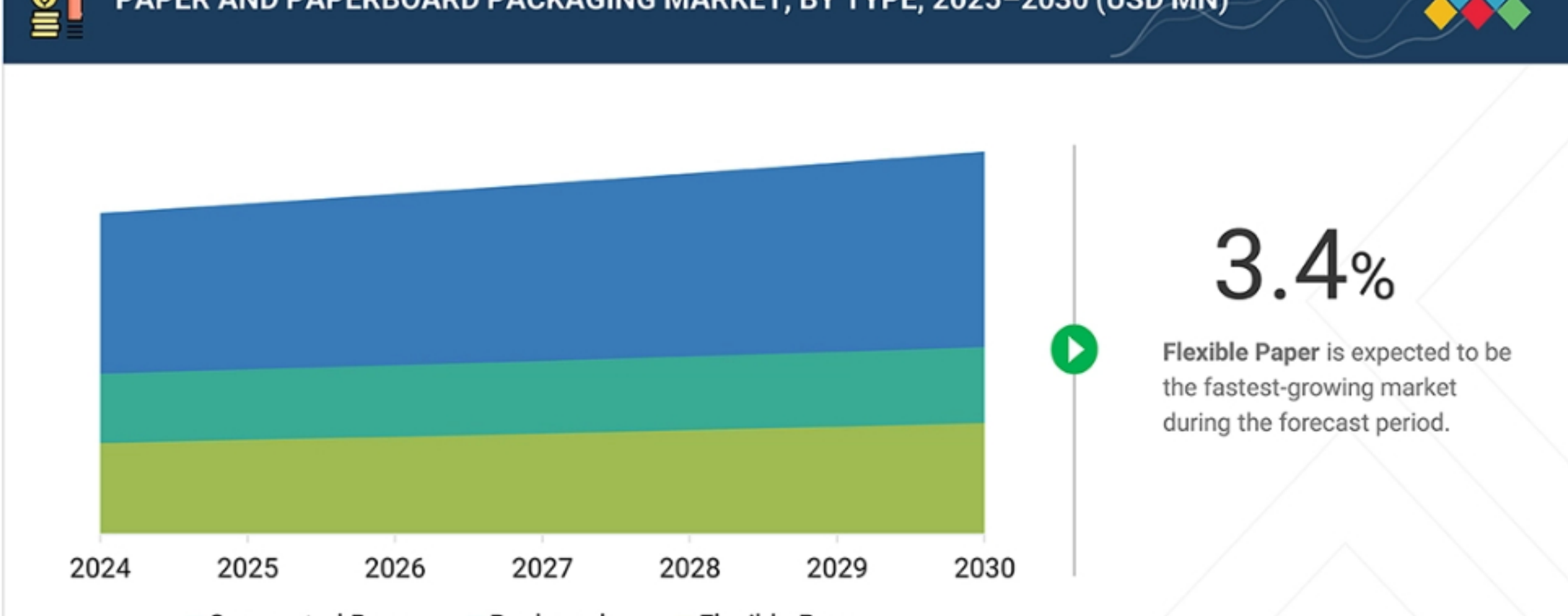
MARKET ECOSYSTEM

The paper and paperboard packaging market features a tightly integrated value chain, covering raw material procurement, manufacturing, and end-use industries like food, e-commerce, healthcare, and consumer products. It relies on virgin and recycled fibers, pulp, adhesives, coatings, and barriers, which are processed to achieve the desired strength, flexibility, and printability. Innovation in lightweight packaging, digital printing, and renewable materials boosts efficiency and performance. Regulatory standards, technological advancements, and circular economy practices drive competitiveness and environmental responsibility across the global value chain.



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MARKET SEGMENTS



Source: Secondary Research, Interviews with Experts, MarketsandMarkets Analysis

Paper and Paperboard Packaging Market, By Type	+
Paper and Paperboard Packaging Market, By Grade	+
Paper and Paperboard Packaging Market, By Applications	+

REGION

Asia Pacific's urban growth and growing end-use application areas drive paper and paperboard packaging demand

The APAC dominates the paper & paperboard packaging market due to urbanization, population growth, and increased demand for sustainable packaging driven by e-commerce and retail expansion. The region's manufacturing hubs and access to raw materials offer cost advantages. Local sustainability initiatives and consumer awareness promote recyclable options, while technological advances boost quality and aesthetics for various products. Low labor costs and investments further strengthen APAC's market position.



*CAGR PERIOD (2025-2030) | REGIONAL MARKET SIZE (2024) | REGIONAL MARKET SHARE (2024)

PAPER AND PAPERBOARD PACKAGING MARKET: COMPANY EVALUATION MATRIX

International Paper (Star) dominates the paper and paperboard packaging market due to its diversified product range, robust global supply chain, and extensive experience in sustainable packaging. It is an innovation-driven company serving markets including food and beverage, e-commerce, and consumer goods, with operational excellence and customer-centric product offerings that adapt to the changing needs of industries. On the other hand, Nippon Paper Group has emerged as a leading player, driven by its significant investment in R&D, adoption of state-of-the-art technologies in production, and commitment to sustainable sourcing. The group has adopted a partnership approach with specialty brands, offering sustainable packaging solutions that further strengthen its market reputation and competitive advantages.



Source: Secondary Research, Interviews with Experts, MarketsandMarkets Analysis

KEY MARKET PLAYERS

- Mondi Group (UK)
- International Paper (US)
- Smurfit Kappa (Ireland)
- NIPPON PAPER INDUSTRIES CO., LTD. (Japan)
- Amcor (Switzerland)

MARKET SCOPE

REPORT METRIC	DETAILS
Market Size in 2024 (Value)	USD 379.95 Billion
Market Forecast in 2030 (Value)	USD 451.80 Billion
Growth Rate	CAGR of 2.9% from 2025-2030
Years Considered	2021-2030
Base Year	2024
Forecast Period	2025-2030
Units Considered	Value (USD Million/Billion), Volume (Kiloton)
Report Coverage	Revenue forecast, company ranking, competitive landscape, growth factors, and trends
Segmentations Covered	By Type: - Corrugated Box - Boxboard - Flexible Paper By Grade: - Solid Bleached Sulphates (SBS) - Coated Unbleached Kraft Paperboard (CUK/SUS) - Folding Boxboard (FBB) - White Lined Chipboard (WLC) - Glassine & Greaseproof - Label Paper - Others By Application: - Food - Beverage - Personal care & Homecare - Healthcare - Others
Regions Covered	North America, Asia Pacific, Europe, South America, the Middle East & Africa

WHAT IS IN IT FOR YOU: PAPER AND PAPERBOARD PACKAGING MARKET REPORT CONTENT GUIDE